

Freezer temperature incident - Store 018

Incident SF-018-2026-044 | August 9, 2026 | Closed after inventory reconciliation and facilities repair

Situation	Frozen-food case FZ-2 displayed 46°F during opening checks; the overnight logger showed the temperature rose above 10°F at 2:14 a.m.
Decision	Escalate for review - stop sale, isolate the case, quarantine affected product, and contact the food-safety and facilities owners.
Reasoning	The product temperature and exposure duration were unknown. Store employees could preserve evidence and protect customers but could not decide that food was safe or return it to sale.
Outcome	All affected product was quarantined and destroyed after approval. No customer sales occurred after the temperature excursion. Facilities replaced a failed condenser fan and verified the case at -2°F for two hours.

Completed response

1. The opening manager stopped sales from FZ-2, placed a physical barrier on the case, and disabled affected frozen SKUs in the store's handheld picking queue.
2. A second employee photographed the display, thermostat, door seals, and logger history. The manager recorded the first observed temperature, time, case number, and last documented normal reading.
3. Employees moved product to labeled quarantine carts in the locked receiving freezer without mixing it with saleable inventory. They recorded SKU, quantity, lot code when visible, and product temperature from a sample in each category.
4. The manager called the food-safety line and facilities dispatch. The handoff included the temperature timeline, product readings, affected categories, last normal check, and confirmation that sales were stopped.
5. Cashiers received a temporary SKU alert. Customer service checked transactions after 2:14 a.m.; none occurred because the store had been closed during the excursion.
6. Facilities replaced the condenser fan. The manager did not reload product until the empty case held 0°F or colder for two continuous hours and Facilities documented the repair.
7. Food Safety authorized destruction of 186 units after reviewing exposure time and sample temperatures. Two employees witnessed disposal and the manager attached the count to incident SF-018-2026-044.

Storefront escalation rules

Escalate immediately	Temperature above the product limit; unknown exposure duration; customer illness report; leaking or swollen packaging; no safe quarantine space; or an unexplained repeat alarm.
Do not	Taste product, reset or unplug equipment before evidence is captured, move uncertain product into saleable inventory, estimate exposure time, or promise a customer that food is safe.
Required handoff	Store number, equipment ID, timestamps, current and historical readings, affected SKUs and quantities, photographs, sales-stop confirmation, and callback number.

Reusable lesson

When cold-storage safety cannot be verified, protect the customer first: stop sale, preserve the temperature timeline, quarantine and count the product, then let Food Safety decide disposition.

Source record: Store 018 opening checklist, freezer logger export, facilities work order WO-88314, quarantine count, and Food Safety disposition approval. All details are fictional and created for SkillVault testing.